

range of vocabulary – which is all spelt correctly, of course. To score a lower grade, but to get the grade they want, students should keep it simple. Of course, if they know the right word or phrase they should use it, but it is more important to make their point simply and clearly. Too many students try to use words and phrases that they have only heard once or twice and don't really understand properly. As for grammar, the same applies. Advanced students will show that they can use all sorts of grammatical structures and score a high mark, but it's just not necessary if you are aiming for a lower score. Lower-level learners should make sure they use basic structures accurately. Then, if they feel confident with more challenging structures, they can try to use them. Students shouldn't try to say what they don't know how to say – they can usually make their point without having to use very complicated grammar.

Track 120

Unit 11 Vocabulary 2

Pronunciation check

The *ough* at the end of words is sometimes pronounced in different ways. Sometimes it is pronounced /ɒ/, sometimes /ʌ/ and sometimes /əʊ/. It is difficult to know which way is correct if you see a new word.

Decide how these words are pronounced.

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| 1 cough | 2 enough |
| 3 though | 4 rough |

Listen and check your answers.

Track 121

Unit 11 Listening 1

B Look at the next part of the flow chart. Listen and complete the notes using no more than two words for each answer.

Voice: If you are not showing those symptoms, you may have another problem. You should ask yourself – do I have a bad cough, and is it difficult to breathe? If it is difficult to breathe or you feel out of breath, you may have bronchitis. Bronchitis is really a bad cold with a cough, but it can last longer than a typical cold and be more difficult to treat. If you have bronchitis you should get plenty of rest and drink lots of water. If you smoke, you will make things much worse by smoking while you are ill. You should try to stop completely while you have the symptoms. You can buy medicine at a chemist that will relieve the pain of the coughing, but you really should contact a doctor immediately if the symptoms don't clear up or get worse.

Now, if you don't have a bad cough, but you do have a runny nose and sore eyes, it could be an allergy. Perhaps you are allergic to something common, like cat hair, or perhaps it's something unusual that you don't know about yet. Explain the symptoms to somebody at a chemist, and they may be able to give you medicine that will help. It might be better to see

your doctor and get some advice, though.

Track 122

Unit 11 Listening 2

A Look at the first part of a flow chart that shows you what to do if you have a headache. Listen and complete the notes using no more than two words for each answer.

Voice: There are various different reasons why you may have a headache. Some of them are not serious and can be treated easily – perhaps by simply taking a painkilling tablet, like an aspirin. Some headaches, however, may be a symptom of something far more serious, and you should get immediate advice.

First of all, ask yourself if you think you have other symptoms that suggest you have a cold. Do you have a fever, a runny nose, a cough or a sore throat? Have you been sick at all? If you have, then you probably have a bad cold or the flu, and the headache is just one of the symptoms. Get plenty of rest and drink plenty of water. There are many types of medicine that you can buy at a chemist, and these will relieve some of the symptoms. Remember, though, medicine will not actually cure the condition, and you might prefer to just drink hot water with some lemon and honey and take a couple of aspirin.

Now, if you don't think you have a cold, you must ask yourself how bad the headache is. If the headache is really bad and you have a stiff neck, there may be a bigger problem. If you feel that normal light is hurting your eyes, it may also be cause for concern. Meningitis is a serious condition. It is caused by an infection of blood around your brain and spinal cord. The condition can seriously affect your brain if not treated immediately. You must see your doctor or go immediately to the nearest hospital.

If you do not show these symptoms, you may still have something that needs treatment quickly. You may have an injury of some kind, and you must try to remember if you have hit your head at all in the last few days. If you have, you may be suffering from concussion. Concussion occurs after an injury to the head, when blood pushes against the brain. It is very serious and you must make sure that you get treatment immediately.

Now, if you don't remember any recent injury, you must ask yourself if you feel ... (*fade out*)

Track 123

Unit 11 Consolidation – Speaking

B Listen to a student talking and answer the questions.

Examiner: OK, so are you ready?

Student: Yes, I think. OK, I was on my bicycle. I was riding quite fast, but there was not much traffic. ... um ... um ... there were a lot of cars parked along the side of the road. One man – he opened the door of the car and, bang, I didn't have time to stop ... um ... I hit the door and came off the bicycle.

Examiner: And?

Student: Err ... oh, yes ... let me see the card again. What did I do? Um ... I was in the road ... and I could see a car was coming towards me. Um ... I jumped up and the first thing I wanted to know was 'is my bicycle OK?' ... I thought I was OK, but I was worried about my bicycle. Um, my bicycle was OK, and I took it to the side of the road. I realized that my chest hurt quite badly. I sat down, and the driver of the car called an ambulance. I discovered that one of my ribs was broken.

Track 124

Unit 11 Consolidation – Speaking

D Listen to the same student trying again. What does he do better the second time?

Examiner: OK, so are you ready?

Student: Yes. Well, this was about a year ago. I was on my bicycle, and I was riding quite fast on a main road. It was a new bicycle, and I was really happy with it – maybe I was riding too fast. There wasn't much traffic, but there were a lot of cars parked along the side of the road. Suddenly, the driver of one car opened the door of his car. I'm sure he checked to see if any cars were coming, but he didn't see me on my bicycle. I tried to brake, but I didn't have time to stop and, bang, I hit the door and came off the bicycle. Then, I remember that I was lying in the road, and I could see a car was coming towards me. I jumped up and the first thing I wanted to know was 'is my bicycle OK?' I thought I was OK, but I was worried about my bicycle. My bicycle was OK, and I took it to the side of the road – the pavement, I think. That is when I realized that my chest hurt quite badly. I sat down, and the driver of the car called an ambulance. I soon discovered that one of my ribs was broken.

Track 126

Unit 12 – Speaking 2

A Think about how you could answer these questions from the first part of the speaking exam. Then listen to some students and tick the speaker who gives a better answer.

Question 1 – Speaker 1

Examiner: What sort of climate does the area you live in have?

Student 1: Sometimes it's hot, and sometimes it's cold.

Question 1 – Speaker 2

Examiner: What sort of climate does the area you live in have?

Student 2: Well, it's quite an extreme climate. Summers are usually very hot and sunny, but winters are very cold. There's usually snow in January and February.

Question 2 – Speaker 1

Examiner: Tell me about the weather in your country.

Student 1: It's always very hot.

Question 2 – Speaker 2

Examiner: Tell me about the weather in your country.

Student 2: Well, it depends on the time of year. In summer, it's always very hot and dry. The temperature can reach forty-five degrees. It doesn't rain for months. In the winter, it is quite cold, especially at night. It rains a lot in spring.

Question 3 – Speaker 1

Examiner: Is there one season that you especially like?

Student 1: Yes, I like spring. I always feel happy because winter is over and it's like a new start. The weather is nice, but it's not too hot.

Question 3 – Speaker 2

Examiner: Is there one season that you especially like?

Student 2: Yes.

Examiner: Err ... which season do you like?

Student 2: I like summer.

Question 4 – Speaker 1

Examiner: Do you do the same things in summer as in winter?

Student 1: No.

Examiner: Oh, err ... so you different things in the winter?

Student 1: Yes, different things in the summer and the winter.

Question 4 – Speaker 2

Examiner: Do you do the same things in summer as in winter?

Student 2: Um, well, a lot of things are the same. I go to work the same, and spend free time with my family, but some things are different. During the summer, I take my little girl to the park a lot and have days out with her. In the winter, we stay at home more. During the winter, I go skiing at least once a month.

Track 127

Unit 12 – Speaking 3

Pronunciation check

Notice how the *-ture* at the end of *temperature* is pronounced. Here are some more words that have the same ending.

Listen and then practise saying them.

- 1 picture
- 2 nature
- 3 adventure
- 4 culture

Track 128

Unit 12 – Listening 1

B Listen to the weather forecast and check your predictions.

Voice: Tomorrow will be another wet day across most of the country. The south-east can expect the worst of the weather, with heavy rain early in the day. Towns along the south-east coast may experience severe storms with thunder and lightning. Later in the day conditions should improve, but showers are still likely in most places during the afternoon. It will also be cold for the time of year, with the temperature remaining at around six degrees.

Track 129

Unit 12 – Listening 1

C Listen again and complete the notes. Use no more than two words for each answer.

[Play track 128 again]

Track 130

Unit 12 – Listening 2

B Listen to the conversation and check your predictions.

Male 1: Oh, no – is it raining out there?

Male 2: Raining? It's absolutely pouring down. They said on the weather forecast that it would rain, but I didn't think it would be like this. How come you're not wet?

Male 1: Ah, well, I heard the forecast, too, so I took a taxi from the station.

Male 2: Mm, you're lucky. I'm absolutely soaked. It's really chilly out there, too. I hope I don't get pneumonia!

Male 1: Well, never mind. They say it's going to get better later on.

Male 2: Yes, but that doesn't help me. I'm going to be in these wet clothes all day!

Track 131

Unit 12 – Listening 2

C Listen again and complete the lines. Use no more than two words for each answer.

[Play track 130 again]

Track 132

Unit 12 – Listening 4

A Listen to the four extracts and match them with the descriptions below.

Extract 1

Voice: Hi, everyone – I'm a bit nervous about doing this, so ... err ... Anyway, as you all know, I come from Libya, and I'm going to talk about sandstorms. Sandstorms are very common in the Sahara desert, and so people in Libya, which is near the Sahara desert, know all about them. Now, we say 'sandstorm', but it's not really a storm – there's no rain or thunder and lightning. There are sandstorms when a strong wind picks up sand and carries it. As the wind blows, the sand in the wind causes more sand to move around, and that is also picked up. A very strong wind can pick up a huge amount of sand – look at my first image on the board, here. As you can see, a severe sandstorm looks like a huge wall or wave of sand. Can you imagine that coming towards you? Now, I will tell you what you should do if you know a sandstorm is coming, or even if you get caught in a sandstorm ...

Extract 2

Female 1: So, have you decided where you're going on holiday yet? You were talking about Spain.

Female 2: No, we've changed our minds. We're going to Egypt for two weeks.

Female 1: Wow, really? When are you going?

Female 2: The second week in August.

Female 1: Egypt in August – you're brave. It'll be absolutely boiling then, won't it?

Female 2: Yeah – that's what I want! We'll go and see the sights early in the morning when it's still quite cool, and then lie around by the swimming pool in the midday heat.

Female 1: Mm, I went to Morocco in the summer a few years ago. I couldn't sleep until about two in the morning. I always said that if I went anywhere like that again, I'd go in the spring or autumn.

Female 2: Well, I can't wait. You just see my tan when I get back!

Extract 3

Female: Good evening, Professor Drake, and welcome to the programme.

Prof: Good evening.

Female: Now, as we have heard, it appears that there are a greater number of hurricanes now, particularly in the Atlantic, and that hurricanes are becoming more violent and causing more damage. First of all, could you explain what causes a hurricane?

Prof: Yes, certainly. Hurricanes – or tropical cyclones, as they are also known – are really huge storms, or a number of storms that occur together within a small area. They are caused by low pressure and moist air rising from the Earth's surface – usually the surface of the sea. As the moist air rises it becomes warmer, and this is what forms the hurricane. If the hurricane is strong enough, it will develop an eye. The eye, which is circular, is at the centre of the hurricane and can be huge – three hundred kilometres in diameter, perhaps. The eye is usually calm – it is the area around the eye – the eyewall – where the storms occur. The eyewall surrounds the eye like the wall of a huge vertical passage, and is made up of the strong winds that cause the damage when the hurricane passes over land. Spreading out from the eyewall is the vast area of clouds and rain that we call the rain bands. These rain bands can spread for hundreds of kilometres.

Female: Thank you for that, professor. Now, why is it that the world is experiencing a greater ... *(fade out)*

Extract 4

Voice: Floods occur when the water level rises in an area where there was previously little or no water. Floods can be dramatic – they occur suddenly, and the water level rises quickly – or creeping – the water level rises over a longer period of time. They occur either because there is a larger amount of rainfall in an area than is usual, or because ice melts. Floods generally cause damage and negatively affect the economy of an area, but they can also be beneficial. The River Nile floods annually, and the water brings nutrients to the soil in surrounding fields. This, of course, means better crops. Most floods occur naturally, but they can be ... *(fade out)*

Track 133**Unit 12 – Listening 4****B Listen again to each extract and complete the tasks below.**

[Play track 132 again]

Track 134**Unit 12 – Writing 2****C Listen to the discussion and circle the option you hear.**

Teacher: So, personally, I have quite strong views about this issue, but I want to hear what you have to say. I don't need to practise my English. I'll tell you what I think at the end. Now, I'm not going to ask individual people what they think, but I'd like to hear from everyone, if possible – OK? So ...

Student 1: Well, I have mixed feelings. I think zoos are quite cruel, but I enjoy going to them. I like to see animals that I know I will probably never see in the wild – like tigers and elephants.

Student 2: But if you really want to see them, you can go on a safari or a jungle trek.

Student 3: No, that's not true for everyone – safaris are really expensive and you don't see all the animals you want to see anyway.

Student 2: I think in this day and age, people can see wild animals on TV all the time. There are really realistic DVDs and Internet pages.

Student 1: But that's not the same as seeing the real animal.

Student 2: I think it's better to see an animal on TV in its natural environment – hunting or playing with its babies – than see it in a little cage at the zoo looking miserable. Big animals that hunt, like lions, tigers and bears, always look very unhappy in a zoo. I heard that they don't live as long in a zoo as they do in the wild.

Student 4: Yes, in my country, zoos are not very well-kept. The children shout at the animals and sometimes even throw things at them. The animals suffer from stress.

Student 1: Well, somebody should stop them doing that. In most countries, zoos are better these days. Animals are in big cages and they can climb and run around.

Student 2: Um, I'm not so sure. When did you last see a lion chasing a zebra in a zoo?

Student 1: Well, there are some big wildlife parks in most countries. Lions might not hunt zebras, but they are free to walk around. People drive their car through the park and take photos.

Student 2: Yes, maybe they are better than small zoos, but they can't keep every type of animal. People go to a zoo to see as many animals as possible.

Student 3: Yes, and these days there are lots of interactive activities, too – like in a museum.

Student 1: People say that zoos are cruel, but I think some species of animal would become extinct if there were not zoos. Zoos help them to survive and keep them safe.

Student 3: Yes, that's true – animals like pandas in China find it very difficult in the wild because their homes are destroyed. They are safer in zoos, and people can help them to produce more pandas. I know it's not perfect to have animals in zoos, but one day it may be the only place that many types of animal exist.

Student 4: I really hope not. People should be doing more to protect the environments of animals in the wild.

Teacher: Um, that's true, but I think it's a whole new question. So – do you want to hear what I think?

Track 135**Unit 12 – Consolidation – Speaking****C Listen to some students and match the answers they give to the questions in Exercise B.**

Speaker 1: Yes, I think so. We are cutting down forests to build towns and cities, and using the wood from the forests for industry. We are polluting the air and the seas and rivers.

Speaker 2: Yes, I think everyone can see that it is. The ice is melting in the Arctic and Antarctic, and some countries are getting hotter. There are natural disasters, like hurricanes, in more places now.

Speaker 3: Yes, especially big animals like pandas and rhinos that people love. They must have special places where humans are not allowed to build and animals are safe from hunters.

Speaker 4: Mm, I'm not sure. It seems to rain much more than it did when I was little, but maybe I just remember the sunny days.

Speaker 5: Yes, if any more ice melts, some parts of the world will be under water. Some islands will disappear. I heard that some diseases from Africa and Asia will be common in Europe if it gets any warmer.

Track 136**Unit 12 – Exam practice – Listening****A You will hear someone talking to some students about how to stay safe when there is lightning. Look at the notes below carefully before you listen.**

For questions 1–10, complete this student's notes. Use no more than three words or a number for each answer.

Voice: Now, a big storm can be quite exciting, and you may want to go outside or stand by a window to get a better view, especially if it's not something you have seen much of before. However, it's not really a good idea. Thunder and lightning can be very frightening, and lightning can be very dangerous, too. You will all know that recently there have been a lot of storms, and that's why I want to warn you of the dangers.

Now, first of all, if you can hear thunder that means the storm is close, and it's close enough for you to be struck by lightning. Lightning can strike as far as fifteen kilometres away from the centre of the storm. Have you tried counting how many seconds

there are between the thunder you hear and the flash of lightning that you see? The less you can count, the closer the centre of the storm. If there's less than thirty seconds between the thunder and the lightning, there is a danger.

If they say on a weather forecast that there will be a thunderstorm you should cancel any outdoor activities that you have planned, especially if they are in areas where it will be difficult to get to safe cover. Don't go camping and don't play golf. Avoid any activities near still water, like fishing – water conducts electricity.

If you are outside when a thunderstorm starts, take cover inside a building as quickly as possible. If there are no buildings and you have a car, shelter in that. Make sure all the windows are closed. Sheltering under a tree or in a bus stop is not really safe – you do not have as much protection as you should. If you are in an open space, don't put up an umbrella and, whatever you do, don't use a mobile phone. The metal directs electricity into the body and can make any injury much worse. Anyone who is swimming or rowing a boat must get to dry land as quickly as possible.

Inside your home there are dangers, too. Don't take a bath or a shower when there is a thunderstorm – if lightning strikes a house, it can send surges of electricity through metal pipes. If a storm appears to be serious, unplug electrical appliances, like TVs and music systems. If the light goes out during a storm, try to use a torch – lighting matches or holding cigarette lighters inside the house is very dangerous.

Finally, don't go out or leave your shelter too soon after the storm has passed. Many lightning strikes occur after the storm has passed. Stay indoors for at least half an hour. Now, I hope I haven't frightened you too much, and I hope you enjoy the rest of ...
(fade out)

Track 137

Unit 12 – Exam practice – Listening

- B** You will hear an English family talking about their holiday options. Read the statements carefully before you listen. For questions 11–16, mark each of the statements on the following page with one of the following abbreviations.

Mother: OK, since we're all together for a change, let's talk about holidays. It's the summer holiday soon, and Dad and I have been discussing some places that everyone might like. Now, I don't want arguments, so let's hear what everyone has to say. Justin, have you thought about a summer holiday yet?

Justin: Can we go skiing again?

Ellie: I don't want to go skiing – not in the summer. It was freezing last time we went skiing – I had the flu for most of the holiday.

Mother: OK, Ellie – let's calm down. We can all make suggestions. We don't have to decide on anything today.

Father: Mum and I were talking about Turkey. Lots of

people go to Turkey in the summer. It's very popular at the moment. There's lots to see and some lovely beaches to relax on, too.

Justin: Yeah, but it'll be absolutely boiling – probably about fifty degrees.

Father: I think you're exaggerating a bit, Justin.

Justin: Maybe. But anyway, you know I get bored just lying on the beach all day.

Mother: Yes, but like Dad said, there's lots to see as well. We can go for day trips to sights and museums.

Ellie: Boring!

Father: I was thinking we could spend some time by the beach, and then go up to Istanbul for a few nights.

Mother: Mm, I don't know about that. I don't really want to go anywhere that's too crowded. I want to get away from stress – not go looking for it.

Father: Well, OK – perhaps just a day trip, then. I'd like to see it. They say it's one of the most exciting cities in the world.

Justin: A day trip from the coast to Istanbul – no way. We'd be on the bus for five hours there and five hours back. That's not my idea of fun.

Mother: OK, it's just one of the options. I said we don't have to decide anything today. I wouldn't mind staying in this country. We could drive to Cornwall or the Lake District. We could go up to Scotland – we've never been there.

Ellie: Mm ... except ... it'll be wet every day – probably pouring down most days. That's the trouble with holidays in Britain.

Father: Look ... we're not getting very far here, are we? Everyone is saying where they don't want to go and nobody is being very positive.

Justin: I said I want to go skiing.

Track 138

Unit 12 – Exam practice – Listening

- C** You will hear a lecturer talking about avalanches. Look carefully at the questions and at the diagram and box of words. For questions 17–19, complete the notes. Use no more than two words for each answer.

Voice: Most of you have probably never experienced an avalanche – they only occur in mountainous areas and not very often – but you've probably seen one on TV.

The most dangerous type of avalanche occurs when snow is loose and wet. Wet snow is very heavy – it moves slowly, but it causes a huge amount of damage. Most avalanches are started by the victim – that means the person who starts the avalanche is usually killed or injured in it. Not many avalanches destroy towns or villages, like you see in movies. People think that the wind can cause an avalanche, but that's not true. The wind can make snow loose and dangerous, but it doesn't actually make the avalanche start.

Now, look at this diagram on the board. Right at the top here, you see the trigger. That means the

cause – what makes the avalanche start. It's usually a person walking on loose, unstable snow. Below that is the start zone – the area where the avalanche builds up, and the snow starts moving. As the snow starts to move with more force, it creates a track. This is the path down which the snow slides. As the snow moves, it creates its own track. As more snow becomes loose, it follows the track down the mountain. On each side of the track are the flanks. The snow here is pulled into the track by moving snow. Finally, down here at the bottom, is the debris toe. This is where the avalanche ends. It will either be on the mountain, where there is not a steep enough slope for the snow to continue moving downwards, or it will be at the bottom of the mountain. Obviously, if it's the bottom of the mountain, a huge amount of damage could be caused. As I said before, however, this is not common, and ... *(fade out)*

For questions 20–24, match some of the words A–H in the box with the numbers on the diagram. Write the letters in the spaces.

[Play track 138 again]

Track 140

Unit 13 Speaking 2

A Listen to some students describing their homes.

Which statement below is true?

Speaker 1: Mm, my apartment is very small, but very expensive. On the other hand, it's very close to where I work, so I save money on bus fares.

Speaker 2: I rent a house with some friends. It's not in very good condition, and my room is small, but I guess it's cheap, and it's better than being at home with my parents.

Speaker 3: I moved to a new house with my husband last year. It's very comfortable, and in a part of the city that we like. However, our neighbours are not very friendly, and they make a lot of noise.

Speaker 4: My apartment is right next to a busy main road – it's really noisy, and the windows are always black! On the plus side, it's very central, and I can walk everywhere.

Track 141

Unit 13 Speaking 2

B Listen again and fill each space with one word.

Notice the incomplete highlighted phrases.

[Play track 140 again]

Track 142

Unit 13 Speaking 2

Pronunciation check

Listen again to sentences 1, 3 and 4 in Exercise B. Notice how the speaker pauses when a linking device introduces a contrast.

Practise saying the sentences.

Track 143

Unit 13 Listening 2

B Listen and complete the notes that one of the tourists made. Use one word only for each answer.

Voice: OK, is everybody still with me? Good. Now, before we walk up to the building, I would like to tell you a few things. You will enjoy looking around the building more if you have some background.

As I'm sure you know, many people think the Taj Mahal is the most beautiful building in the world, and I hope you now understand why. Look at the gardens and how they have been designed. They are the same on both sides of the building, so there is a sense of symmetry. The fountains and pools create a sense of calm. You will see as we approach the building that it is reflected in a large pool. This is where most tourists stop to take their first photos, and I'm sure you will, too.

We will see the building up close, of course, but from here what you notice is the dome on top of the building and the four towers, or 'minarets' as they are properly called, in each corner. Most people are surprised by the size of the dome and wonder at how its weight is supported. When you are closer you will see how the light at this time of the day makes the dome appear a blue-white.

Now, I expect most of you will know something about the story behind the Taj Mahal, but I will quickly summarize for those who do not. It is a truly romantic story – perhaps the most romantic story ever told. Shah Jahan was one of the most important men in India. He had built wonderful constructions all over the north of India. Suddenly, in 1629, his favourite wife died and the Shah was terribly sad. They say his beard turned white in one night. He wanted to create something to remember her by, and he decided to build the most beautiful monument he could imagine. The work started in 1632. It was finished thirty years later. 20,000 men worked on the construction.

Unfortunately, Shah Jahan did not have very long to enjoy his project. His son ... *(fade out)*

Track 144

Unit 13 Listening 3

- B Listen to part of a lecture that an architect is giving about the Millennium Dome. Read the summary below before you listen. For questions 1–8, complete the summary with words that you hear. Use no more than two words for each answer.**

Voice: Now, you might ask why the Millennium Dome is so unpopular – why people are so upset by it. After all, there are ugly buildings all over the world. Blocks of flats and office blocks in every city in the world are truly unpleasant to look at. I'm sure you have plenty of ugly buildings in your city.

However, the important difference is that the Millennium Dome was not constructed quickly and cheaply like some 1950s block of flats. It was built to celebrate a special occasion. It took years of planning and years of construction – and it cost an enormous amount of money – not far off a billion pounds.

The Millennium Dome is supposed to be beautiful. It is, however, quite horrible. It was built to bring one of the world's great cities into the twenty-first century. Now, less than ten years later, nobody wants to look at it. I am afraid that it will always be famous for its ugliness.

In the United States we have our ugly buildings, too. The Chicago Public Library is a good example and the Experience Project Museum in Seattle is awful. But there is something about the Millennium Dome that makes it worse – in my opinion, at least.

I admit that the design of the building is ambitious and, of course, is a great achievement of engineering. However, I'm afraid that for me that is not enough. To my mind, the Millennium Dome was, and is, a huge disappointment.

So, what will become of the building now? I understand that it has been bought by a company that hope to turn it into a venue for entertainment events, like shows and concerts. I suppose that considering how much it cost, it is good that it will be used for something. Personally, however, I would prefer to see it pulled down.

Speaker 4: The heating didn't work, and it took the landlord a month to repair it.

Speaker 5: The furniture was old, and some of it was broken. There were only two cooking pans and we didn't have enough plates or glasses.

Track 147

Unit 14 Speaking 1

Pronunciation check

When the form of a word changes, the stress usually falls on a different part of the word. The noun is *technology*. The adjective is *technological*. Listen and mark where the stress falls in these related words.

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| 1 photograph | 2 photography |
| 3 photographic | |

Track 148

Unit 14 Speaking 2

- B Listen to some students. Match each answer with a question above.**

Speaker 1: Oh, it has changed every aspect of people's working lives. In factories, for example, machines have replaced people completely, and now do the most repetitive jobs. In offices, people spend much more time looking at a computer screen than they ever did before.

Speaker 2: Well, I think the way we travel around will change. Everyone has a car now, so it's actually sometimes a slow way to get around. I think people who have money will want something faster, like a small helicopter or some kind of flying car.

Speaker 3: Well, I suppose they do. Personally, I love to go camping because I like to get back to nature. I find it a bit strange when I see other campers with lots of machines and gadgets, such as computer games and portable TVs.

Speaker 4: I suppose life at work has changed the most, especially the way I communicate with people. I e-mail people all the time – even people on the same floor! I don't use the phone nearly as much as I once did.

Track 145

Unit 13 Writing 1

- D Listen to some people talking about problems they had when they rented an apartment. Did you mention any of the same things?**

Speaker 1: I moved in and the apartment was really dirty. The agency hadn't arranged for anyone to clean it properly.

Speaker 2: The landlord kept coming round to the house without telling us first. He just walked in – right in the middle of a meal or a movie.

Speaker 3: The shower didn't work, so I had to have a bath all the time. It took a long time for the water to get hot.

Track 149

Unit 14 Speaking 2

- C Listen again and complete the sentences. Use one or two words in each space.**

[Play track 148 again]

Track 150

Unit 14 Listening 1

- D Listen to four people talking about the inventions and check your ideas.**

Speaker 1: Most people probably don't realize what a clever thing a boomerang is. People think they're

toys or used for sport. In fact, they were the very first objects made by human beings that were heavier than air and could fly. They were used for weapons and for hunting. The oldest Aboriginal boomerangs date back to 10,000 years ago. At that time, they would have been very advanced in terms of technology.

Speaker 2: Of course, it's not really clear who exactly invented the television – a number of different scientists and inventors were working on similar projects at the same time. But a man from my country, John Logie Baird, is the man who created the first working television system. He first demonstrated his invention to the public in 1925.

Speaker 3: Everyone knows that we have achieved a huge amount in terms of space exploration. The space race between ourselves and Russia went on for nearly twenty years, but we were the first to land a man on the Moon. At that time, the space race was very close, and the Russians very nearly got to the Moon before us. For me, the most exciting invention, and the invention that really showed we were ahead in the space race, was the reusable space shuttle. It was first successful in 1981 and has since been used on many missions.

Speaker 4: Although the remains of very early ovens have been found in many parts of the world, it was here that they were first used frequently in people's homes.

In ancient Greece and in other parts of Europe and Turkey, it seems that people used ovens to bake bread. But it seems there was only one large oven that everyone shared. Here, the remains of villages from 5,000 years ago show that each mud-brick house was constructed with an oven, and that baking bread and perhaps cooking meat was common.

Track 151

Unit 14 Listening 1

E Listen again. Can you hear different accents? Who do you think has the strongest accent?

[Play track 150 again]

Track 152

Unit 14 Listening 2

A Listen to each speaker say more about each invention and complete the tasks. For questions 1–5, choose five answers from A–H. Which of these statements about boomerangs does the speaker make?

Speaker 1: Most people probably don't realize what a clever thing a boomerang is. People think they're just toys or something used for sport. In fact, they were the very first objects made by human beings that were heavier than air and could fly. They were used for weapons and for hunting. The oldest Aboriginal boomerangs date back to 10,000 years ago. At that time, they would have been very advanced in terms of

technology. The remains of boomerangs have been found in North Africa, India and parts of America, but it's the Aboriginal boomerang that everyone knows about. When it's thrown correctly it follows a curved path and comes back to where it was thrown from. Some boomerangs are only about ten centimetres long, but the biggest can be over two metres. Not all boomerangs are designed to come back to the thrower. Hunting boomerangs, some of which are still used by Aborigines in Australia, are designed as flat throwing sticks and are used for hunting. These boomerangs that followed a straight path and flew very fast were actually more difficult to make, and it could be that the famous returning boomerang was actually invented by accident as attempts were made to develop a faster hunting weapon. Nowadays, boomerangs are made mainly for tourists. It can be quite difficult to learn to throw one so that it comes back to you, and you may need a few lessons before you can do it properly.

For questions 6–11, listen and complete the flow chart. Use one word only for each answer.

Speaker 2: Of course, it's not really clear who exactly invented the television – a number of different scientists and inventors were working on similar projects at the same time. But a man from my country, John Logie Baird, is the man who created the first working television system. He first demonstrated his invention to the public in 1925. At one of London's most famous department stores, Logie Baird demonstrated how silhouette images could be seen to move on a screen. In 1926, he demonstrated his invention again – this time at his laboratory, to the Royal Institute and to reporters from the *Times* newspaper. The quality of the projected image had improved greatly and the event is considered to be the first real demonstration of a television system. In 1928, Logie Baird developed his invention and demonstrated the first transmission in colour.

For questions 12–16, complete the notes. Use no more than three words or a number for each answer.

Speaker 3: Everyone knows that we have achieved a huge amount in terms of space exploration. The space race between ourselves and Russia went on for nearly twenty years, but we were the first to land a man on the Moon. At that time, the space race was very close, and the Russians very nearly got to the Moon before us. For me, the most exciting invention, and the invention that really showed we were ahead in the space race, was the reusable space shuttle. It was first successful in 1981 and has since been used on many missions. The reusable shuttle can carry astronauts on space missions and can serve as a laboratory in which to conduct experiments. It can be used to transport equipment to space stations, or to collect or repair satellites. The shuttle carries

between five and seven crew members. When a mission is complete, the shuttle fires thrusters, which propel it back into the earth's atmosphere. It then glides down to make its landing.

For questions 17–19, complete the short summary. Use no more than two words for each answer.

Speaker 4: Although the remains of very early ovens have been found in many parts of the world, it was here that they were first used frequently in people's homes. In ancient Greece and in other parts of Europe and Turkey, people used ovens to bake bread. But it seems there was only one large oven that everyone shared. Here, the remains of villages from 5,000 years ago show that each mud-brick house was constructed with an oven, and that baking bread and perhaps cooking meat was very common. The ovens were made of clay and shaped like a beehive. Inside they had shelves, so that a number of loaves could be cooked together, and an opening at the bottom from which ash could be removed.

Track 155

Unit 15 Vocabulary 2

Pronunciation check

When one word ends in a consonant and the next begins with a vowel, you hear the consonant sound at the beginning of the second word rather than at the end of the first.

Listen to these examples from the unit.

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| 1 social issues | 2 drug abuse |
| 3 serious offences | 4 have been arrested |

Practise saying the phrases.

Track 156

Unit 15 Speaking 3

B Listen and answer these questions.

1

Examiner: Are there any crimes that are particularly common in your country?

Student: Mm, I think we have the same as other countries. But one crime that is a big problem is, erm ... you know, when somebody takes a child and asks for money ...

Examiner: You mean kidnapping?

Student: Yes, kidnapping. It is a big problem in my part of the world.

2

Examiner: Do you feel that London is a safe city to stay in? Is it as safe as Switzerland?

Student: No, not really. I think people are a little more aggressive. Sometimes, I think there will be a fight. The first flat I stayed in was on the ground floor, and there was a ... erm ... when someone comes in the flat and he steals things, erm ... anyway, that happened in my first flat. I wanted to move to another one after that.

Examiner: Oh, I'm sorry to hear about that.

Track 157

Unit 15 Listening 1

B Listen to somebody giving a talk about homelessness and check your ideas.

Part 1

Voice: Good evening. I'm so pleased that so many people have attended my talk. I know many of you are concerned about the number of homeless people that there are in the town centre. I know a lot of you will feel that the situation is becoming worse and that nobody is doing anything about it. However, I think that coming along this evening shows that you want to know more about homelessness and understand the issue, and not simply see it as a problem that affects you as individuals.

Now, I'll start by explaining what 'homeless' means – and it means a little more than simply sleeping out in the street. The people you see in parks and gardens, or bus stops and shop doorways, are a small percentage of the people that we class as homeless. People are homeless if they are sleeping on the floor or on the sofa at a friend's house. They are homeless if they are sleeping in a hostel or shelter for homeless people. They are homeless if they are sleeping in a car or any other vehicle. We also class people as homeless if they are separated from family or other people that they would normally live with. People are homeless if they live in conditions that are so bad that their health is affected, and they are homeless if they are in danger of violence or physical abuse. That means, as I said before, that homelessness is a much bigger issue than a few people sleeping in bus stops or shop doorways. This is just what you see.

Part 2

So, why do people become homeless? People do not choose to be homeless. They are not sleeping rough because they have chosen to leave a safe home or families who love them. They are homeless because there is no other option. People become homeless because they are poor – because they cannot afford to pay rent, or sometimes because they cannot afford to pay the mortgage on a house or apartment that they have bought. People become homeless because they lose their job or have never had a job. There are related problems that often result in a person becoming homeless. Many homeless people have a drug addiction – they are either homeless because they spend their money on drugs, or they have become addicted to drugs because they are homeless. A high percentage of homeless people have mental health problems and find it difficult to make the decisions about their lives that most people can make. A number of homeless people are ex-prisoners – when they are released

from prison, it is very difficult to find a job and a place to live. Many people become homeless because the owner of their home – a landlord or landlady – evicts them. If people have lived in the same place for a long time and then suddenly lose it, they can find it impossible to afford the increased rent for a new home. Many people have to move out of the place they live because it is dangerous – a young person may have a violent father, or a wife a violent husband. These people are too afraid to stay in their home, and they risk making themselves homeless. Finally, in many parts of the country there is just not enough housing – certainly not enough housing that poor people can afford. The increase in the value of property has made life difficult for many people – not just homeless people. I'm sure many of you will understand that.

So, how do we deal with a problem as big as this? It isn't easy. In this country, people with very poorly paid jobs or no jobs at all receive some kind of financial support. In some cases, all or part of their rent is paid by the government. This helps to stop people becoming homeless, but if you are already homeless, it doesn't help. Most towns, like this one, have shelters for people who are temporarily homeless, but they cannot stay at them permanently. They have to move on after a certain period of time. Some towns have food kitchens where homeless people can get a meal two or three times a week. The problem is that shelters and food kitchens don't really deal with the cause of the problem – they deal only with the effect. People can stay in a shelter for a while, but it will not help them to find a home of their own – and that is what they need, of course. Now, I'm going to go on in a moment to talk about some of the suggestions that have been made in terms of dealing with homelessness – ideas for dealing with the problem in a more permanent way. I'll also talk about some of the programmes that are in place and are, in some cases, very successful in other parts of the world. Before that, does anyone have any questions about what I have said so far?

Track 158

Unit 15 Listening 2

- B Listen to the first part of the talk about homelessness again and answer these questions. For questions 1 and 2, choose the correct answer a, b or c.**

[Play part 1 of track 157 again]

For questions 3–7, complete the notes. Use no more than three words for each answer.

[Play part 1 of track 157 again]

Track 159

Unit 15 Listening 3

- A Listen to the rest of the talk about homelessness again. Answer the questions. For questions 1–8, complete the summary below with words from the text. Use no more than two words for each answer.**
[Play part 2 of track 157 again]

For questions 9 and 10, choose two answers from A–D.
[Play part 2 of track 157 again]

Track 160

Unit 15 – Exam practice – Listening

- A You will hear two people telephoning their local council to complain. Answer the questions. For questions 1–5, choose the correct answer a, b or c.**

Telephonist: Good morning, you're through to Hereford Council. How can I help you?

Woman: Oh, good morning. I'm telephoning about graffiti. Not for the first time, I might add.

Telephonist: Oh, yes? Where is this graffiti? Which part of the city do you live in?

Woman: I'm in the Port Hall area. It's a quiet residential area – as you probably know. These days I expect to see graffiti all over the city centre, but not round here. I looked out my window this morning and some ... well, someone has sprayed names and football teams all over the wall opposite. There's more on the house on the corner of the street. Can't somebody stop it happening?

Telephonist: I'm sorry. I know graffiti is a problem. Did you phone the police about it?

Woman: What's the point? I didn't actually see anyone spraying. What can the police do the next morning? There should be cameras in the streets. Then you'd know who did it. Oh, it makes me so angry.

Telephonist: Um, I'm not sure about having cameras in residential areas. A lot of people already think there are too many cameras in the street as it is.

Woman: Well, do you think you could tell me who's going to clean it off? You can't expect the people who own the houses to keep cleaning it off every time it happens.

Telephonist: Well, I'm afraid it is the responsibility of the owner to clean up graffiti. I know it's not really fair, but we just don't have people to come out and clean up all over the city. Walls usually need to be repainted.

Woman: And what about graffiti on telephone boxes and lamp posts – whose job is it to clean that off?

Telephonist: Well, that is the council's responsibility, but we can't promise that it will be done straightaway.

Woman: No, I didn't think you could. You know who I blame? The parents ... If only they ... *(fade out)*

For questions 6–10, choose five answers from A–H. Which of the following is the man unhappy about?

Telephonist: Good morning, you're through to Hereford Council. How can I help you?

Man: Oh, hello there. I'm phoning about the rubbish collections. Why the rubbish hasn't been collected again this week, to be more specific.

Telephonist: Oh, I see. Which part of the city do you live in?

Man: I live in Chester Road. That's in the West Cliff area.

Telephonist: And which day is your rubbish normally collected?

Man: Well, who knows? I thought it was supposed to be Friday, but it seems to be a different day every week at the moment. Some weeks there isn't even a collection. I'm really fed up with it.

Telephonist: Mm, the collection in West Cliff is supposed to be Tuesday, but the council has had a few problems recently. A new company has taken over the collection. It's taking a while to get the operation running smoothly. They had an issue with their drivers last month – I think that meant that collections were affected.

Man: Well, it's not good enough. If the rubbish isn't collected the streets look terrible. Seagulls fly down and peck at the bags for food. They pull the rubbish all over the street. For the last three or four weeks I've had to go outside and sweep up the rubbish and put it in a new bag. I'm too busy to keep doing that every week.

Telephonist: Yes, I understand.

Man: You know, things are bad enough even when the collection is regular. Some neighbours put their rubbish outside the house whenever they like, anyway. They are supposed to put it out on the Tuesday morning – they know that, but they don't care. By the time the lorry comes round, the rubbish is all over the street.

Telephonist: Well, people know they shouldn't put their bags outside until Tuesday morning. If you know who's doing it you can tell us what number they live at and we'll call them.

Man: Mm, I don't see why the men who do the collection can't pick up some of the rubbish that's in the street. They just throw the bags in the lorry and leave the loose rubbish where it is in the street.

Telephonist: I'm afraid it's not their job to clean the streets. They are paid to collect the bags from outside the houses – no more than that. The street cleaner comes to West Cliff on a Wednesday.

Man: Ah, yes – well, that's another thing ... *(fade out)*

Track 162

IELTS Target 5.0. Three mock tests.

TEST 1

You will hear a number of different recordings and you will have to answer questions on what you hear. There will be time for you to read the instructions and questions and you will have a chance to check your work.

All the recordings will be played once only. The test is in four sections.

SECTION 1

Now turn to section one.

(four-second pause)

Section one. You will hear a conversation about a language course. First, you have some time to look at questions 1–5.

(fifteen-second pause)

You will see that there is an example that has been done for you. On this occasion only, the conversation relating to this will be played first.

Receptionist: Good morning, Borgheimer Language Courses. How may I help you?

Customer: Oh, yes. I contacted you some time ago about following a German course in Germany, and you advised me to take your placement test before we go any further. Well, I've done that now, so I'd like to go ahead with booking the course for this summer, if that's possible.

Receptionist: Certainly, sir. You said you took the placement test. What was the result?

Customer: I was placed at the O3 level.

Receptionist: O3. Right, that's Lower Intermediate. Fine, Mr ...?

The answer is 'Level Three or Lower Intermediate', so the course level has been filled in for you. Now we shall begin. You should answer the questions as you listen because you will not hear the recording a second time. Listen carefully and answer questions 1–5.

(four-second pause)

Customer: Pettersson. John Pettersson.

Receptionist: Could you spell that for me please, Mr Pettersson?

Customer: P, E, double T, E, R, double S, O, N.

Receptionist: That's a double T and a double S, am I right?

Customer: That's right. Now, could I ask you where the course takes place?

Receptionist: Well, we offer courses in Hamburg and Berlin. For your level, there's never a problem. There are always plenty of people for the intermediate classes.

Customer: Oh, dear. Does that mean that there might be a lot of students in my class? I wouldn't be very happy about that.

Receptionist: No, don't worry, Mr Pettersson. The maximum class size is 12, but I've never known there to be more than nine or ten in a class. It could even be five or six.

Customer: Good. Actually, I'd prefer to study in Berlin. And how long is the course?

Receptionist: Three weeks, five hours a day. Two hours only on Saturday. Sundays free.

Customer: I see, and what about accommodation?

Receptionist: There you have a choice, Mr Pettersson. You can either stay with a German family, who are used to having such guests, or you can stay on the university